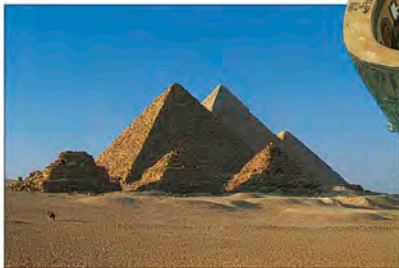




# THE EGYPTIANS

The Egyptians believed that when they died they went on to another, everlasting, life. To live happily in the afterlife, they needed their earthly bodies and great care was taken to ensure that they arrived in style. The dead bodies were preserved in a special way called mummification.

To mummify a body took a long time, as much as 70 days. First, inner organs were taken out and put in tightly sealed jars. Next, the body was dried out by covering it with natron, a white powder like salt. It was left for 40 days, rubbed with sweet-smelling oils, and then covered in molten resin. Finally, the body was wrapped in linen to make a neat package.



## Royal tombs

Egyptian kings, called pharaohs, were buried in tombs known as pyramids.



*A picture of the dead person is painted on the mummy case, or coffin.*

*On this coffin, the arms are shown crossed over the chest.*



*The coffin is made to follow the shape of the body inside.*

*These little drawings are called hieroglyphs. Each picture means a word or sound in the ancient Egyptian language.*

## Well kept

This is how the mummy of King Seti I looks underneath all his bandages. He was buried at Thebes over 3,000 years ago. Despite his age, you can still see his face very clearly.

